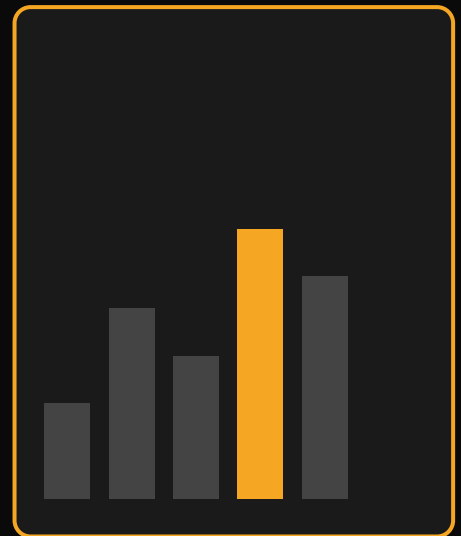


STOP FLYING BLIND

The Complete GA4 + Shopify Analytics
Setup Guide for Small Business



GA4

SEARCH CONSOLE

GOOGLE ADS

SHOPIFY

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This guide is for Shopify store owners and ecommerce operators who are either flying blind — no analytics set up properly, no idea what's working — or drowning in data that doesn't make sense. By the time you finish, you'll have a working analytics stack, five essential reports, and a clear view of what's actually driving (or killing) your revenue.

Introduction

Why Your Analytics Are Probably Lying to You

Most Shopify store analytics are broken. Not "slightly off" — broken. Inflated traffic numbers, missing revenue data, sessions attributed to the wrong channel, conversion rates that don't match your actual sales. And because the numbers look plausible, most business owners never question them.

You make decisions based on those numbers. You spend money based on those numbers. And then you wonder why your marketing feels like it's not working.

The Four Most Common Ways Your Data Is Already Wrong

1. You Installed GA4 But Didn't Configure It

Installing the tracking code gets you some data — but without proper configuration, you're missing purchase events (the most important thing), accurate channel attribution, internal traffic exclusions, cross-domain tracking, and proper event parameters.

2. Your Shopify and GA4 Aren't Talking Properly

Shopify has its own analytics. GA4 has its analytics. They should agree — they almost never do. Causes include checkout subdomain breaks, payment gateway redirects (Afterpay, Zip, PayPal) that lose attribution, duplicate tracking from old apps, and native integration misconfiguration.

3. You're Looking at Vanity Metrics

Sessions. Pageviews. Bounce rate. These feel useful — but can you draw a direct line from any of them to revenue? The metrics that actually matter: revenue by channel, conversion rate by source, average order value, customer acquisition cost, and return customer rate.

4. You're Missing Attribution Windows

Someone clicks your Instagram post, browses but doesn't buy. Three days later they Google your brand name and buy. In most default GA4 setups: Google / organic gets full credit. The Instagram post that started the journey gets nothing. If you cut your Instagram budget based on last-click data, you might be killing the top of a working funnel.

What "Fixed" Looks Like

When your analytics stack is set up properly, you can answer these questions confidently:

- Where did my revenue come from this month?
- What's my cost per new customer, by channel?

- Which products have the best (and worst) conversion rates?
- Where are people abandoning their carts?
- Are my Google Ads profitable?
- What percentage of my orders are from returning customers?
- What's changed since last month, and why?

A Note on GA4 vs Universal Analytics

Universal Analytics (UA) was deprecated in July 2023 and historical UA data is no longer accessible through the standard interface. GA4 is built on an event-based model rather than session-based — more flexible but more confusing out of the box. This guide is written entirely for GA4. If someone tells you to do something "the old way," verify they're not giving you UA advice dressed up as GA4 advice. It happens constantly, and it leads to broken setups.

The Analytics Stack That Actually Works

Four free tools. Properly connected.

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	COST
Google Analytics 4	Tracks user behaviour, conversions, revenue by channel	Free
Google Search Console	Shows search rankings, clicks, impressions, indexing status	Free
Google Ads	Paid traffic management + conversion tracking	Ad spend only
Shopify Analytics	Order/revenue reporting — your source of truth for revenue figures	Included
Google Tag Manager	Manages all tracking tags from one place (optional but recommended)	Free

Why These Four Tools, Not Others

There are dozens of analytics tools marketed at ecommerce businesses — Triple Whale, Northbeam, Rockerbox, Littledata, and more. Some are genuinely excellent. Most are expensive. The tools above are free, deeply integrated with each other and with Google Ads, and they're what any agency or freelancer will know how to use. Once this stack is working correctly, you'll have the foundation to layer in paid tools if you need them. But you don't need them to start.

Shopify Analytics — Your Revenue Source of Truth

Shopify knows about every order placed on your store. When there's a discrepancy between Shopify and GA4, **trust Shopify for revenue figures**. GA4 can miss transactions due to ad blockers, slow page loads, or tracking gaps. Shopify can't miss an order because an order is what generates money.

GA4 Setup Checklist

10 Steps — Work Through Every One

Work through every step below, even if you think your GA4 is already set up. Most "already set up" GA4 accounts are missing at least three things on this list.

1 Create or Access Your GA4 Property

- Go to analytics.google.com — sign in with your business Google account (not personal Gmail)
- Click the Admin gear icon (bottom left) → check you're in the right Account and Property
- If no GA4 property exists: Click Create Property → set name, timezone (Australia/Sydney), currency (AUD)
- Select business type (Shopping or Retail) → Business objectives: "Examine user behaviour" and "Generate leads/sales"
- If a property exists: Verify it shows a G-XXXXXXXXXX Measurement ID (not UA-XXXXXXXXXX which is deprecated)

2 Configure Your Data Stream

- In Admin → Property → Data Streams → Add stream → Web
- Enter your website URL (e.g., <https://yourstore.com.au>)
- Leave Enhanced Measurement turned ON — automatically tracks scrolls, outbound clicks, video plays, file downloads
- Copy your Measurement ID (format: G-XXXXXXXXXX) — you'll need this to connect to Shopify

3 Configure Data Retention — Do This Immediately

- In Admin → Property → Data Settings → Data Retention
- Change Event data retention from 2 months to 14 months
- Turn on "Reset user data on new activity"
- Click Save
- Why this matters: Without 14-month retention, you cannot run year-on-year comparisons. You'll only notice this is a problem about 6 months after you needed to fix it.

■ Warning

The default 2-month retention is one of the most damaging "default" settings in GA4. Change this on Day 1. There is no way to retroactively recover data you didn't retain.

4 Filter Out Internal Traffic

- Find your IP address at whatismyip.com — note all locations (home, office, etc.)
- In Admin → Data Streams → click your web stream → More tagging settings → Define internal traffic
- Click Create → Name it "Internal — [Your Name/Office]" → IP address matches regex → enter your IP
- Then: In Admin → Data Settings → Data Filters → Internal Traffic → Change status from Testing to Active
- Without this filter, a store owner who checks their site 10 times a day can account for 5–10% of their own "traffic".

5 Set Up Cross-Domain Tracking

- In Admin → Data Streams → click your web stream → Configure tag settings → Configure your domains
- Add your main domain AND your checkout domain (e.g., yourstore.com.au + checkout.yourstore.com.au)
- For most standard Shopify stores, Shopify's native GA4 integration handles this. If using GTM, this step is critical.

6 Mark Referral Exclusions for Payment Gateways

- In Admin → Data Streams → web stream → Configure tag settings → List unwanted referrals
- Add every payment gateway you use: paypal.com, afterpay.com, zip.co, zippay.com.au, hummm.com.au, klarna.com, laybuy.com, openpay.com.au
- Without exclusions, GA4 treats the return from a payment gateway as a new session — making all purchases appear to come from "paypal / referral"

7 Configure Google Signals

- In Admin → Property Settings → Google Signals Data Collection → Get Started
- Follow the activation steps → Click Activate
- Improves remarketing audiences and cross-device reporting. Optional but recommended.

8 Link Google Search Console

- In Admin → Property Links → Search Console Links → Link
- Select your Search Console property and your web stream → Submit
- If you haven't verified your site in Search Console yet, do that first (covered in Section 8)

9 Link Google Ads

- In Admin → Property Links → Google Ads Links → Link
- Select your Google Ads account → Enable auto-tagging → Submit
- Auto-tagging adds a `gclid` parameter to your Google Ads URLs, allowing GA4 to attribute sessions to specific campaigns, ad groups, and keywords

10**Verify Your Setup (24–48 Hours After Connecting)**

→ Check 1 — Real-time: Open your store in an incognito window. In GA4 → Reports → Realtime → you should appear within seconds.

→ Check 2 — Purchase events: Place a test order (use Shopify's Bogus Gateway in Settings → Payments → Test mode). Look for a purchase event in Realtime.

→ Check 3 — Enhanced Measurement: Scroll a product page. Look for scroll events in Realtime.

→ Check 4 — Revenue data (after 24h): Go to Reports → Monetisation → Ecommerce Purchases. Confirm you see product data.

→ If any of these fail, fix the foundation before moving on.

Key Events to Track

(And Which Ones Don't Matter)

GA4's event-based model means you can track almost anything. The question isn't what you can track — it's what's actually worth your attention.

Events You Must Have — Non-Negotiable

EVENT	WHAT IT CAPTURES	WHY IT MATTERS
purchase	Completed transactions with revenue, items, order ID	Your most important conversion event
add_to_cart	Product added to cart	Top of the purchase funnel
begin_checkout	Checkout started	Middle of the funnel — measures drop-off
add_payment_info	Payment details entered	Near-bottom of funnel
view_item	Product page viewed	Understanding product interest
view_item_list	Collection/category page viewed	What categories get attention

If you're using Shopify's native GA4 integration (via the Google & YouTube Sales Channel), all of these fire automatically. If you're using GTM, you'll need to configure them manually.

Events That Are Useful — Track These Too

EVENT	WHAT IT CAPTURES	WHY IT MATTERS
search	On-site search queries	Shows what customers can't find easily
view_promotion	Banner/promotion interactions	Measures effectiveness of homepage promotions
remove_from_cart	Items removed from cart	Identifies consideration-stage hesitation
login	Account logins	Tracks returning customer engagement
sign_up	Account creation	Newsletter/account growth tracking

Configuring Conversions

In GA4, a "conversion" is any event you mark as important. You should mark:

- In Admin → Events → find purchase → toggle "Mark as conversion" to ON
- Also mark begin_checkout (useful for funnel analysis)
- Optionally mark add_to_cart if you want to track micro-conversions

■ Important

Do NOT mark page_view or session_start as conversions. This is a surprisingly common mistake — it makes your conversion rate look astronomically high and renders the metric meaningless.

Shopify + GA4 Connection

Three Methods — Choose the Right One for Your Store

Method 1: Shopify's Native Google Integration (Recommended)

Shopify's Google & YouTube Sales Channel includes built-in GA4 integration. This is the simplest approach and covers 80–85% of tracking needs for most stores.

What it tracks automatically: All standard ecommerce events (view_item, add_to_cart, begin_checkout, purchase), user sessions, pageviews, product and revenue data.

What it doesn't cover: Some advanced custom events, granular parameter customisation, and certain edge cases with third-party payment gateways.

- In Shopify Admin → Apps → Browse apps → search for "Google & YouTube" (Shopify's official channel app)
- Click Add app → Install → Get started
- Connect your Google account — use the same account connected to your GA4 property
- Under Analytics → Connect to Google Analytics → Select your GA4 Property → Connect
- Verify: Browse your store in incognito. In GA4 → Reports → Realtime → you should see events firing within 30–60 seconds.

■ Check for Duplicate Tracking

If you previously had another GA4 integration (an older Google Analytics app, a third-party Shopify plugin, or a manually placed tag), you may now have duplicate tracking. Signs: double-counted pageviews, GA4 showing twice Shopify's revenue, inflated conversion rates.

To check: Open your store → F12 → Network tab → browse to a product page → filter for "g/collect" requests. If your GA4 Measurement ID appears twice, you have duplicate tracking.

To fix: Remove any manually added GA4 scripts from your Shopify theme and disable/remove any older Google Analytics apps.

Method 2: Google Tag Manager (Advanced — More Flexible)

If you want more control over what's tracked and how — or if you're also tracking Meta/Facebook, TikTok, or other platforms — GTM is the better long-term choice.

Why GTM? One place to manage all tracking tags, handles complex custom events, easier to update without touching code, works better for stores with custom checkout flows.

→ Go to tagmanager.google.com → Create account → enter business name and website URL → Target platform: Web

→ Copy the two code snippets provided (head snippet and body snippet)

→ In Shopify Admin → Online Store → Themes → Actions → Edit code → open `theme.liquid`

→ Paste the GTM head code immediately after the tag

→ Paste the GTM body (noscript) code immediately after the tag → Save

→ In GTM → Tags → New → Google Analytics: GA4 Configuration → enter your Measurement ID → Trigger: All Pages → Save

→ Click Submit → Add a version name → Publish (nothing goes live in GTM until you publish)

■ Tip

The Google Analytics Debugger Chrome extension is invaluable for testing GTM setups. Install it, enable it, and you'll see exactly which events are firing and what data they contain.

Method 3: Manual Script (Avoid If Possible)

Manually adding the GA4 tracking code to your theme works, but it's the least flexible option. You can't manage events from a central place, it's harder to debug, and it breaks more easily with theme updates. Only use this if Methods 1 and 2 aren't suitable for your situation.

The 5 Reports Every Shopify Owner Needs

Build these. Read them every week.

These five reports cover the questions that matter for a Shopify store. Each one tells you something actionable. Each one can be built in GA4 without a paid tool.

Report 1: Revenue by Channel

The question it answers: Where is my money actually coming from?

Your most important report. Revenue broken down by traffic source — paid search, organic search, email, social, direct, and referral.

Building it in GA4:

- Go to Explore (compass icon in left nav) → Blank
- Name it "Revenue by Channel"
- In Dimensions, add: Session default channel group, Session source / medium
- In Metrics, add: Total revenue, Transactions, Average purchase revenue, Sessions, Session conversion rate
- Drag Session default channel group to Rows box → Drag all metrics to Values box
- Set date range to last 30 days

Benchmarks and what to look for:

METRIC	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Total Revenue	Gross revenue attributed to this channel
Transactions	Number of completed orders
Avg Purchase Revenue	Average order value per channel
Sessions	Total sessions from this channel
Session Conversion Rate	% of sessions from this channel that resulted in a purchase

Report 2: Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)

The question it answers: How much does it cost to get a new customer from each channel?

The report most small business owners never build — and the one that would change their marketing decisions more than anything else. $CAC = \text{Channel Spend} \div \text{New Customers from that Channel}$.

Building it — requires combining data from three sources:

- Step 1: Get new customer counts by channel from GA4 → Explore → New Users and Transactions by channel
- Step 2: Get spend data from Google Ads → Campaigns → spend by campaign type for the same date range
- Step 3: Build a simple table: Channel | Spend | New Customers | CAC
- Rule of thumb: Aim for LTV:CAC ratio of at least 3:1. Under 1:1 = losing money acquiring customers. Over 5:1 = under-investing in growth.

Report 3: Top Landing Pages

The question it answers: Which pages are bringing in revenue-ready visitors?

Not all entry points are equal. Someone who lands on a specific product page is much closer to buying than someone who lands on your blog.

Building it in GA4:

- Explore → Blank → Name it "Landing Page Revenue"
- Add dimension: Landing page + query string
- Add metrics: Sessions, Transactions, Total revenue, Session conversion rate, Bounce rate
- Sort by Total Revenue descending → Show top 50 rows

Report 4: Cart Abandonment Funnel

The question it answers: Where exactly in the checkout process are people dropping off?

This is where recoverable revenue lives. Understanding exactly where in the funnel people drop off tells you where to focus your optimisation energy.

Building it in GA4:

- Go to Explore → Funnel exploration
- Name it "Purchase Funnel"
- Add steps: 1) view_item 2) add_to_cart 3) begin_checkout 4) add_payment_info 5) purchase
- Set to Closed funnel (users must go through steps in order)
- The drop-off percentages between each step are your optimisation targets

Benchmarks and what to look for:

METRIC	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
view_item → add_to_cart	Benchmark: 5–15%. Below 5% = product pages need work (pricing, images, descriptions, reviews)
add_to_cart → begin_checkout	Benchmark: 25–40%. Below 25% = cart page issues (shipping cost surprise, trust signals missing)
begin_checkout → purchase	Benchmark: 50–70%. Below 50% = checkout friction (too many steps, payment options missing)

Report 5: Return Customer Rate

The question it answers: What percentage of my orders are from customers who've bought before?

Return customer rate is one of the most important indicators of business health. A business with a high return rate has proven product-market fit and a lower effective CAC.

Building it in GA4:

- In Explore → Blank → Name it "New vs Returning"
- Add dimension: New / Returning
- Add metrics: Sessions, Transactions, Total revenue, Average purchase revenue
- Also check Shopify's native Returning Customers report under Analytics → Reports → Customers

Benchmarks and what to look for:

METRIC	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Benchmark for healthy ecommerce	25–40% of orders from returning customers. Under 20% = retention problem worth addressing immediately.
High return rate + lower AOV	Common — returning customers buy more often but in smaller amounts. Often normal.
New customer dominant	If 80%+ of orders are always new customers, your retention strategy needs work.

Your Weekly Analytics Ritual

15 Minutes. Every Monday. Non-negotiable.

Most business owners either never look at their analytics, or drown in them. Neither works. This is the middle path: a structured 15-minute ritual that answers the most important questions every week, consistently.

The 15-Minute Monday Morning Check

Minutes 1–3: Open GA4 → Reports → Realtime. Quick sanity check — is tracking working? Any obvious anomalies?

Minutes 4–8: Open your Revenue by Channel report. Compare this week vs last week and this week vs same week last year. What's up? What's down? Any channel shift that warrants attention?

Minutes 9–11: Open your Cart Abandonment Funnel. Any funnel stage that dropped significantly? A checkout drop means a technical issue worth investigating.

Minutes 12–14: Open your Top Landing Pages report. Any page that's suddenly underperforming? Any page that's surging that you can learn from?

Minute 15: Write down one thing you'll investigate or act on this week. One thing. Not ten.

Monthly Deep Dive (First Monday of the Month)

- Review CAC across all channels — is your acquisition cost trending up or down?
- Check your Return Customer Rate — did it improve or worsen this month?
- Review top 10 products by revenue and by conversion rate — any surprises?
- Check your site speed on your top landing pages — any page load regressions?
- Review any A/B tests or changes made last month — what did the data show?
- Set one specific hypothesis to test next month based on what you found

Google Ads + Search Console Integration

Close the loop between your spend and your results.

Google Search Console Setup

- Go to search.google.com/search-console → Add property → URL prefix → enter your full store URL
- Verify ownership via the HTML tag method: copy the meta tag, add it to your Shopify theme's section
- click Verify
- Alternatively, verify via your domain's DNS if you have Cloudflare or similar DNS management
- After verification, submit your sitemap: In Search Console → Sitemaps → enter `your-store.com.au/sitemap.xml` → Submit
- Data takes 2–3 days to start populating. Within a week you'll have query and click data.

Using Search Console Data

Queries report: Shows exactly which search terms bring people to your site. Sort by Clicks to see your top-performing queries. Sort by Impressions but low CTR to find queries where your ranking is good but your title/meta needs work.

Pages report: Shows which pages of your store appear in Google Search. Any page with high impressions but zero clicks = meta title issue. Any important page with zero impressions = indexing or SEO issue.

Google Ads Conversion Tracking

If you're running Google Ads without conversion tracking, you're flying even blinder than before. Without it, Google's algorithm has no signal to optimise toward.

- In Google Ads → Tools & Settings → Conversions → + New conversion action
- Select Website → choose your action (Purchase)
- Set Category: Purchase, Value: Use transaction-specific values (allows GA4 to pass actual revenue)
- Count: One (for purchases — you don't want to count one purchase multiple times)
- The easiest method: In Google Ads, click Import → Google Analytics 4 → select your purchase conversion → Import and continue
- Verify: After setting up, run a test purchase. In Google Ads → Tools → Conversions → you should see "Recording conversions" status within 48 hours

UTM Parameters for Email and Social

UTM parameters are tags you add to URLs in your emails and social posts that tell GA4 where a visitor came from. Without them, all email traffic shows up as "direct" and most social traffic is misattributed.

UTM Parameter Structure

`https://yourstore.com.au/products/your-product?utm_source=klaviyo&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=may-2026-sale`

utm_source: The platform (klaviyo, facebook, instagram, mailchimp)

utm_medium: The channel type (email, social, paid_social, cpc)

utm_campaign: The campaign name (may-2026-sale, black-friday, new-arrivals)

Use Google's UTM builder at ga-dev-tools.google/campaign-url-builder/ to generate these automatically. Add UTMs to every link in every email campaign. Add UTMs to any paid social links. Organic social posts generally don't need UTMs (GA4 can attribute these), but paid social always does.

Reading the Numbers

Benchmarks, Green Flags, and Red Flags

METRIC	BELOW AVERAGE	AVERAGE	STRONG
Overall conversion rate	Under 1%	1–2.5%	Over 2.5%
Cart abandonment rate	Over 85%	70–85%	Under 70%
Return customer rate	Under 15%	15–30%	Over 30%
Email conversion rate	Under 1%	1–3%	Over 3%
Organic search % of traffic	Under 10%	20–40%	Over 40%
Email % of revenue	Under 10%	15–30%	Over 30%
Avg order value (AUD)	Context-dependent	Know your category norms	Growing YoY

Benchmarks are context-dependent. A 1.2% conversion rate is excellent for high-ticket furniture and concerning for a \$30 accessory store. Always compare your metrics to your own historical performance first, then to industry averages second. Trend matters more than absolute number.

Automating Your Reporting

Get the data without manual effort.

GA4 Automated Email Reports

- In GA4 → Reports → open any standard report → click the Share icon (top right) → Schedule email
- Set frequency (daily/weekly/monthly), recipient email addresses, and format (PDF)
- Useful for: Weekly Revenue by Channel summary, Monthly ecommerce overview
- Limitation: Only works for standard reports, not custom Explorations

Google Looker Studio (Free Dashboard Tool)

Looker Studio (formerly Google Data Studio) connects directly to GA4 and Shopify and lets you build custom dashboards that update automatically. It's free, powerful, and much better than looking at raw GA4 reports.

- Go to lookerstudio.google.com → Create → Report
- Add data source → Google Analytics → select your GA4 property
- Drag and drop metrics to build your dashboard: Revenue by channel, conversion rate trend, top products
- Share with stakeholders via link — no Google account required to view
- Shopify connector is also available (third-party, some are free): search "Shopify Looker Studio connector"

■ Recommended Looker Studio Setup

Build one dashboard with 4 views: (1) Weekly revenue overview, (2) Channel performance, (3) Product performance, (4) Funnel health. Bookmark it and open it every Monday morning instead of navigating through GA4. Share the link with your team — everyone seeing the same numbers reduces misalignment.

Common Tracking Mistakes That Cost You Money

We see these in almost every store audit.

Mistake #1: No Internal Traffic Filter

Your own visits inflate traffic numbers and reduce your conversion rate. On a small store, the owner checking the site 10x/day can account for 5–10% of all "traffic." Fix: See Step 4 in the GA4 setup checklist.

Mistake #2: Duplicate Tracking

Having two GA4 integrations running simultaneously — the most common cause of GA4 showing double Shopify's revenue. Fix: Check for multiple GA4 tags firing in the Network tab. Remove older integrations.

Mistake #3: Not Excluding Payment Gateway Referrals

Every purchase through Afterpay, PayPal, or Zip looks like a "referral" from that payment gateway. You lose visibility into what actually drove the sale. Fix: See Step 6 in the GA4 setup checklist.

Mistake #4: Only 2 Months Data Retention

The default GA4 setting. You won't notice the problem until you want to run a year-on-year comparison and realise you have no data older than 2 months. Fix: Change to 14 months in Data Retention settings — Day 1.

Mistake #5: Not Tagging Email Links with UTM Parameters

Without UTMs, all your email traffic shows as "direct" traffic. You can't measure whether your email campaigns are driving revenue. Fix: Add `utm_source=yourplatform&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=name` to every link in every email.

Mistake #6: Trusting GA4 Revenue Over Shopify Revenue

GA4 can miss transactions — ad blockers, slow loads, tracking gaps. Shopify can't miss an order. If they disagree, trust Shopify for revenue figures. Use GA4 to understand behaviour and attribution, not as your financial source of truth.

Mistake #7: Never Verifying the Setup Actually Works

Many stores "set up" GA4 and never check whether purchase events are actually firing. They look at the data for months before realising it's missing half the transactions. Fix: Place a test order. Verify in GA4 Realtime.

Mistake #8: Treating All Traffic Sources Equally

"Traffic is up 30%" is not good news if it's all low-quality bot traffic or brand-new visitors who never buy. Always segment by channel and conversion rate, not just volume.

Analytics Audit Checklist

Run this on any new or existing Shopify store.

GA4 Foundation

- GA4 property created with correct name, timezone (AUS), and currency (AUD)
- Data stream configured with Enhanced Measurement on
- Data retention set to 14 months
- Internal traffic filter created and set to Active
- Payment gateway referral exclusions added
- Google Signals enabled

Shopify Connection

- GA4 connected to Shopify via Google & YouTube app (or GTM — not both)
- No duplicate tracking — only one GA4 Measurement ID firing per page
- Purchase events firing in Realtime (verified with test order)
- Revenue in GA4 within 10% of Shopify revenue (after accounting for test orders)
- Cross-domain tracking configured if using custom checkout domain

Google Integrations

- Google Search Console linked to GA4 property
- Site verified in Search Console and sitemap submitted
- Google Ads linked to GA4 with auto-tagging enabled
- Conversion actions importing from GA4 into Google Ads
- UTM parameters on all email campaign links

Conversions

- purchase event marked as a conversion in GA4
- begin_checkout marked as a conversion in GA4
- page_view and session_start NOT marked as conversions
- Custom events configured for contact_form_submit (if applicable)

Reports

- Revenue by Channel exploration built and bookmarked
- Cart Abandonment Funnel exploration built

- Landing Page Revenue exploration built
- Looker Studio dashboard created (or GA4 email reports scheduled)
- Weekly analytics ritual scheduled in calendar

Next Steps

+ Your Free Audit Offer

You now have everything you need to build a properly functioning analytics stack. The businesses that act on this guide will have a genuine data advantage over competitors who are still guessing.

Do These Three Things Today

1. Run the Audit Checklist (Section 12)

Open your GA4 account and work through every item. Tick off what's working. Note what isn't. Prioritise by impact: data retention and internal traffic filter first, then events and linking.

2. Build Your Revenue by Channel Report

Open Explore in GA4 and build the report described in Section 6. Save it. Bookmark it. This single report will change how you think about your marketing budget.

3. Schedule Your Weekly Analytics Ritual

Put a recurring 15-minute calendar block on Monday mornings. Call it "Analytics Check." Link to your GA4 Explorations. Treat it like you treat your weekly financials — non-negotiable.

WANT US TO AUDIT YOUR ANALYTICS STACK?

We offer a free 30-minute analytics audit for Shopify store owners who've worked through this guide. We'll review your GA4 setup, identify specific gaps, and give you a prioritised fix list.

No fluff. No sales pitch. Just an honest assessment of your current setup.

ignitionagency.au/audit

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